

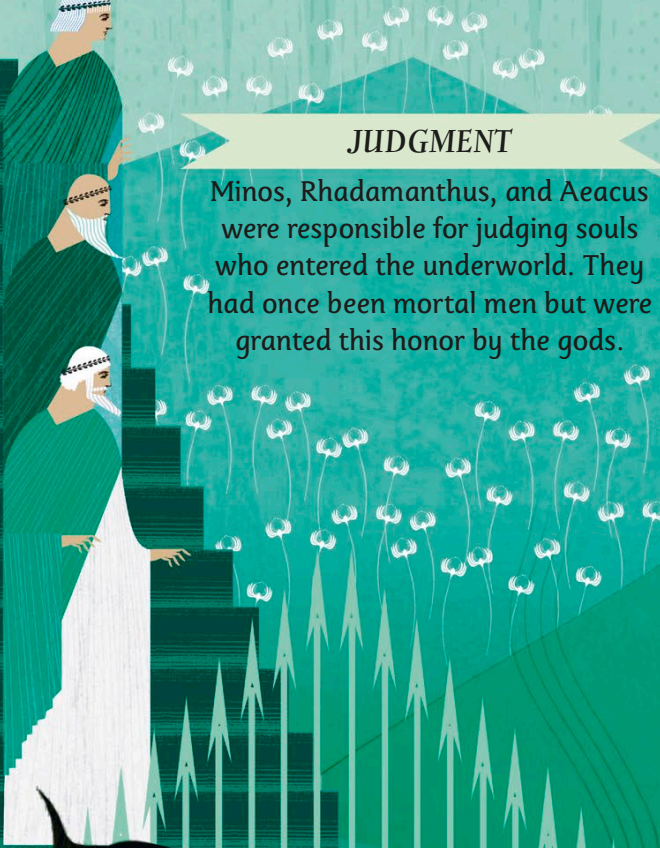


### ASPHODEL FIELDS

The underworld was carpeted with large fields of asphodel—a type of plant with pale white flowers. This plant was the only food that souls could eat.



### JUDGMENT



Minos, Rhadamanthus, and Aeacus were responsible for judging souls who entered the underworld. They had once been mortal men but were granted this honor by the gods.



### GATES TO THE UNDERWORLD



The underworld was protected by huge metal gates that were guarded by the three-headed dog Cerberus. These gates stopped the souls of the dead from escaping.



### THE FURIES



The Furies were three goddesses responsible for punishing people who committed evil acts by driving them insane, both in the land of the living and the dead.

The Furies had large wings that carried them as fast as the wind.

### TARTARUS

Tartarus was the deepest, darkest part of the underworld, where Zeus had imprisoned the Titans who had fought against him. It was also where souls were punished for doing wrong in their lives, such as Tantalus, Sisyphus, and the Danaïdes.



Tantalus's punishment was to stand forever between water and a fruit tree, but never to be able to eat or drink.

### ACHERON RIVER

In order to get to the underworld souls had to cross the Acheron River. They had to pay the ferryman, Charon, one coin to board his boat. If a body hadn't been given a coin in the land of the living, then they would be stuck by the river forever.